CHAPTER 2

Keyboard Patterns & Note Names



The piano looks like 88 different keys -- but it is one small pattern, repeated: a small house of 2 black keys that carries 3 white keys, and a big house of 3 black keys that carries 4. Learn the pattern, and every key on the piano tells you its own name.

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By the end, you can

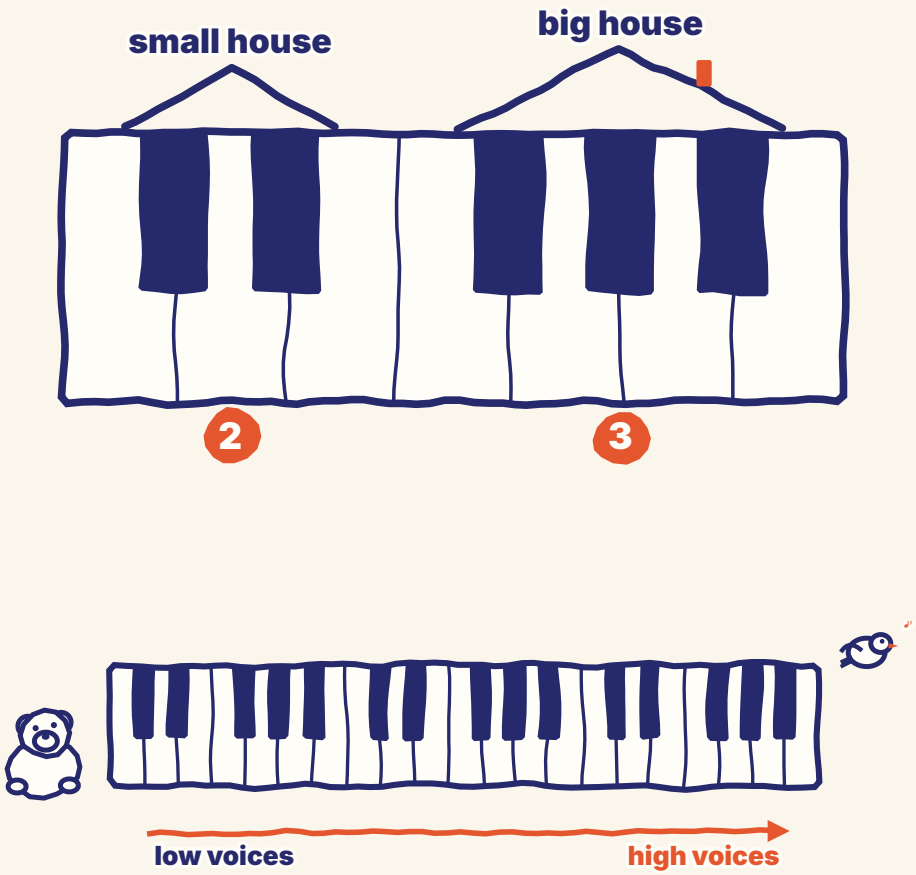
- ✔ find any small house or big house
- ✔ say which white keys belong to each house
- ✔ name every white key, C to B
- ✔ find middle C on a real piano
- ✔ play your first tune on the black keys

Goes with: the Workbook page beside each lesson page, and the online lesson (scan the code below).

TEACHER Pattern first, names second -- the same order at every age. Older beginners take this chapter in one sitting; younger ones live in the patterns for a while before the names stick. No staff yet: the Queen of G and the King of F wait for the Reading chapter -- here we only plant "the low and high voices meet at middle C".

Step 1

Small house, big house



Two black keys together make a small house. **Three** make a big house. Small, big, small, big... the same two houses repeat all the way up the piano. And the street climbs from **left (low sounds) to right (high sounds)**.

At the piano

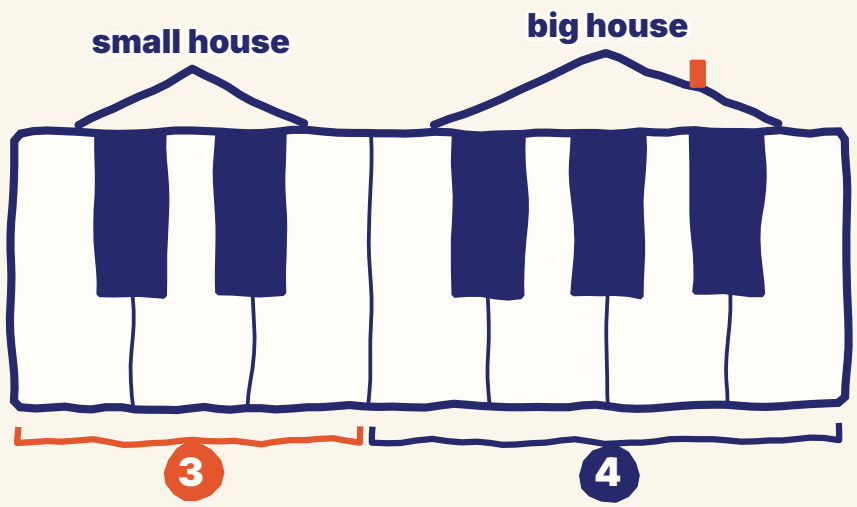
1. Find a **small house** and a **big house** near the middle of the piano. ☐
2. Travel from the very bottom to the very top, saying it out loud: "small house... big house... small house..." ☐
3. Close your eyes. Someone plays one high or one low sound -- point to the end of the street where it lives. ☐

REMEMBER **Small house = 2. Big house = 3. Low on the left, high on the right.**

TEACHER Watch for counting black keys one by one instead of seeing the groups. Say: "Look for the shapes, not the keys -- two together, three together." The bear (low end) and the bird (high end) carry the direction; loud/soft moved out of this chapter.

Step 2

The white keys of each house



The white keys are not just anywhere -- each one **belongs to a house**. The small house carries **3** white keys (left door, inside, right door); the big house carries **4**. 3 + 4 = **7** -- after seven, the street starts again.

At the piano

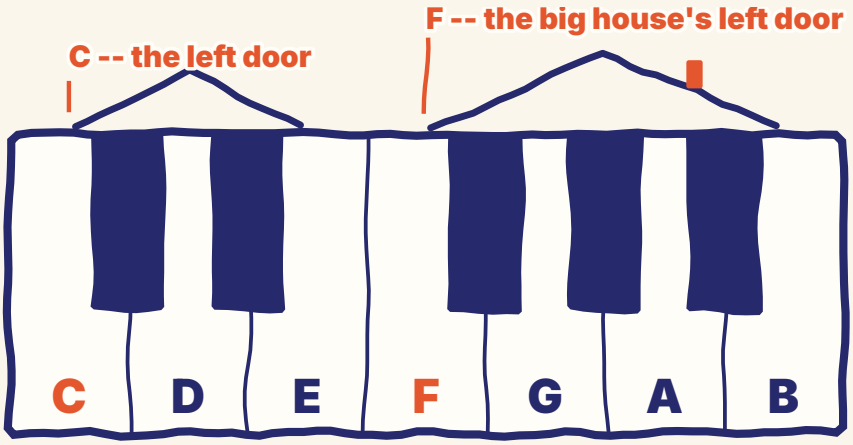
1. Find a small house and play its **3** white keys in turn: left door, inside, right door. ☐
2. Move to the big house next door and play its **4** white keys in turn. ☐
3. Travel up the whole piano saying "three... four... three... four..." ☐

REMEMBER **Every house carries its white keys: 3 at the small house, 4 at the big.**

TEACHER This is the chapter's key idea: the white keys belong to a house. 3 at the small house, 4 at the big one -- 3 + 4 = 7, then the street repeats. A student who sees this grouping finds every note name (and later every scale fingering) from the pattern, not by counting from the bottom.

Step 3

The seven letter names



Music uses just **seven letters**: **C D E** live at the small house and **F G A B** at the big one. **C is the small house's left door** and **F is the big house's** -- learn the two doors, and you can walk to every other name. After G? A again.

At the piano

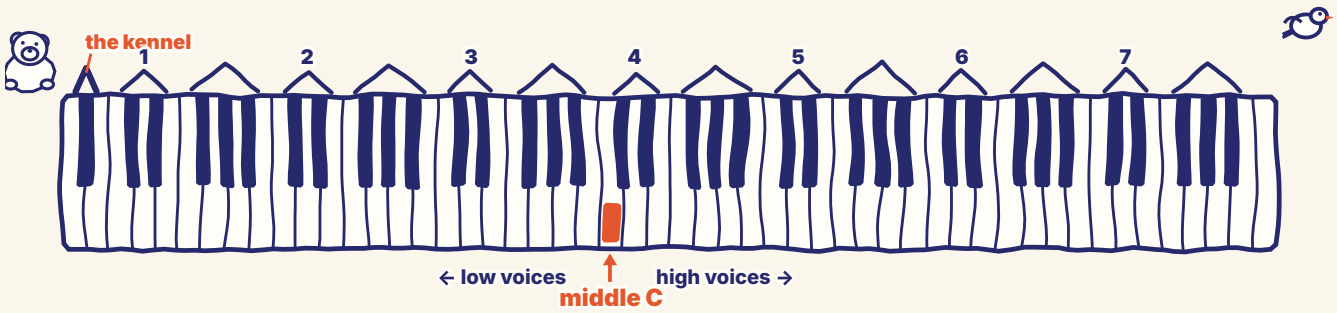
1. From the bottom to the top, find and play **every C** -- one at each small house's left door. ☐
2. Now find and play **every F** -- the big house's left door. ☐
3. Someone says a letter (D, G, B...); use the two houses to find that key and play it. ☐

REMEMBER **C D E at the small house, F G A B at the big -- and after G comes A.**

TEACHER Anchor C and F at their doors; the rest follow by walking. Watch for "H" (there is none -- after G comes A again) and for counting from A at the bottom. Letters only here; 도레미 alongside (Korean mode) is an open choice.

Step 4

The whole piano & middle C



A real piano has **88 keys** -- yet still only 7 small houses and 7 big ones. Count to the **4th small house**: its left door is **middle C**. To its left live the low voices, to its right the high voices -- middle C is **the door where they meet**.

At the piano

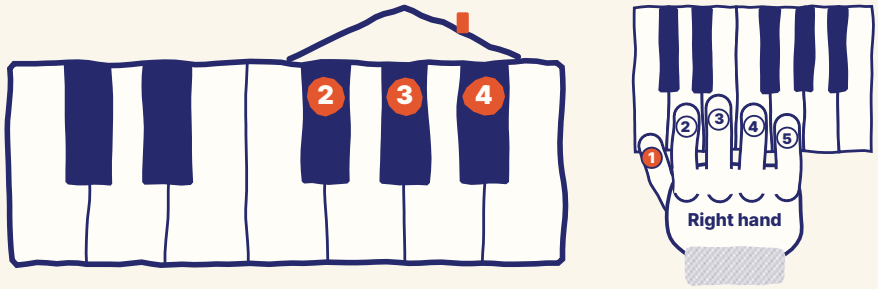
1. Count the **small houses** from the bottom: 1 up to 7, touching each one. ☐
2. Find the **lonely black key** at the very bottom -- right beside it is the lowest key of all. ☐
3. Play **middle C**; then the C one house lower (a lower voice) and one house higher (a higher one). ☐

REMEMBER **Middle C: just left of the 4th small house -- where low and high meet.**

TEACHER Tick each house while counting so none is counted twice. The lonely black key is A♯0/B♭0, the second key from the bottom. "Kennel" for the lonely key -- your call.

Play

Play on the patterns



Now the map pays you back. Your first tune needs no written notes: just the **big house** and right-hand **2, 3, 4**. Play it **smooth as honey** (legato) -- one finger lets go at the exact moment the next one plays.

Hot Cross Buns one circle = one steady beat; a dashed circle = hold one more beat

4 3 2 ◌ | 4 3 2 ◌ | 2 2 2 2 3 3 3 3 | 4 3 2 ◌

At the piano

1. Right-hand **2, 3, 4** on a big house near the middle; sing and play slowly: **4 - 3 - 2...** ☐
2. **Echo:** someone plays two or three black keys; you play them straight back. Take turns. ☐
3. Make up your own black-key tune, give it a name, and play it to someone at home. ☐

REMEMBER **Legato: smooth as honey -- no gaps, no bumps.**

TEACHER 2 3 4 from left to right; check the chapter 1 habits while it plays (round hand, wrist back to level). Legato is the exact hand-over: no gap, no blur. The first tune stays a black-key rote song (Hot Cross Buns) -- or switch to a white-key tune now that the names are known? Echo: 2-3 black keys, straight back; grow to 4-5.

Step 5

My five checks

Show, don't tell! Give yourself a star for each check in each lesson.

		Lesson 1	2	3	4	5	6
	**I can find a small house and a big house anywhere**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	**I can say each house's white keys: 3 and 4**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
C D E F G A B	**I can name any white key (C at the small house's left door)**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	**I can find middle C (just left of the 4th small house)**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	**I can play Hot Cross Buns legato with 2 3 4**	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

 REMEMBER **Pattern first, names second -- the keyboard is a map you can read.**

TEACHER Chapter 1's five checks still come first, every time at the piano. These five are this chapter's own: the student shows you each one on the keyboard; you only correct. All five easy? Do the Chapter check-up in the Workbook.